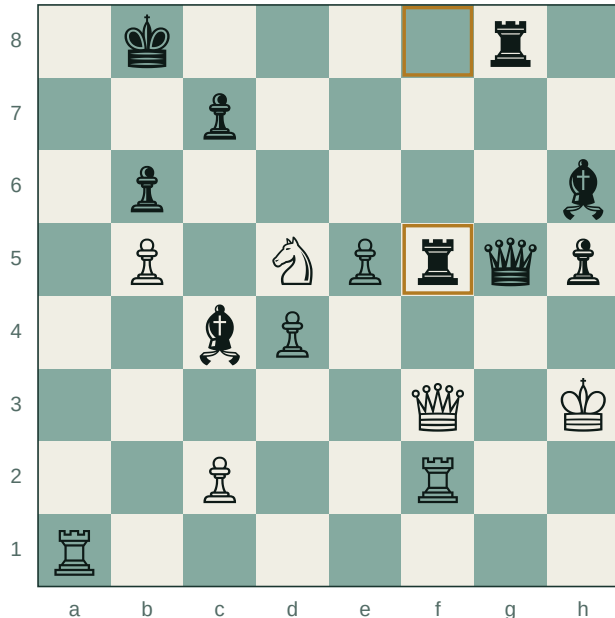


Double checks: White, move 34

Double checks

White to move



Previous move: 33...Rxf5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

34. Ra8+ Kxa8 35. Nxb6+ Ka7 36. Qa3+ Kb7 37. Qa6+ Kb8 38. Qa8#

34.Ra8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **34...Kxa8**.

35.Nxb6+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From b6 it attacks king on a8 and bishop on c4. Recorded reply: **35...Ka7**.

36.Qa3+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The changed line means the rook on f2 attacks the rook on f5. Recorded reply: **36...Kb7**.

37.Qa6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **37...Kb8**.

38.Qa8# Mate: queen on a8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on b8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on a8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on b8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on c4. Check for tactical protection.